SAN MIGUEL COUNTY
Housing Code Update

Community Engagement Plan

BOCC Meeting July 23rd, 2025

SAN MIGUEL COUNTY
COLORADO

Agenda

1. Introductions and Project Team
2. Project Overview
3. Community Engagement Plan Overview
4. Questions

Project Team

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SAN MIGUEL COUNTY COLORADO

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Project Overview

San Miguel County Housing Code Update

- Funded by Colorado Proposition 123 Local Planning Capacity Grant
- Meet Prop 123 Requirements for Fast Track funding eligibility
- Timeline: June 2025 - September 2026 (15 months)
- Goal: Enable more housing choices while preserving community character

The Housing Challenge

The Crisis

1,114
housing units needed by 2034
(218 in unincorporated areas)

195
jobs unfilled annually due to housing barriers

62%
of businesses can't recruit/retain employees due to lack of affordable housing

Nearly half of workers commute 25+ miles to work

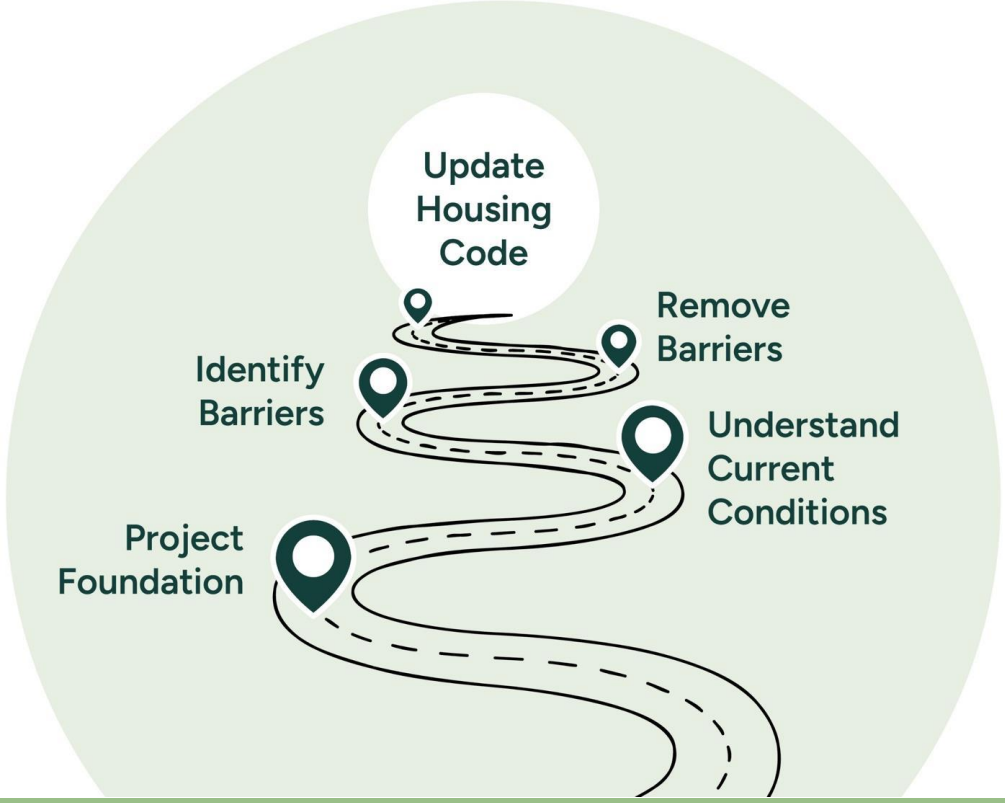
Source: 2025 San Miguel County Housing Needs Assessment

The Opportunity

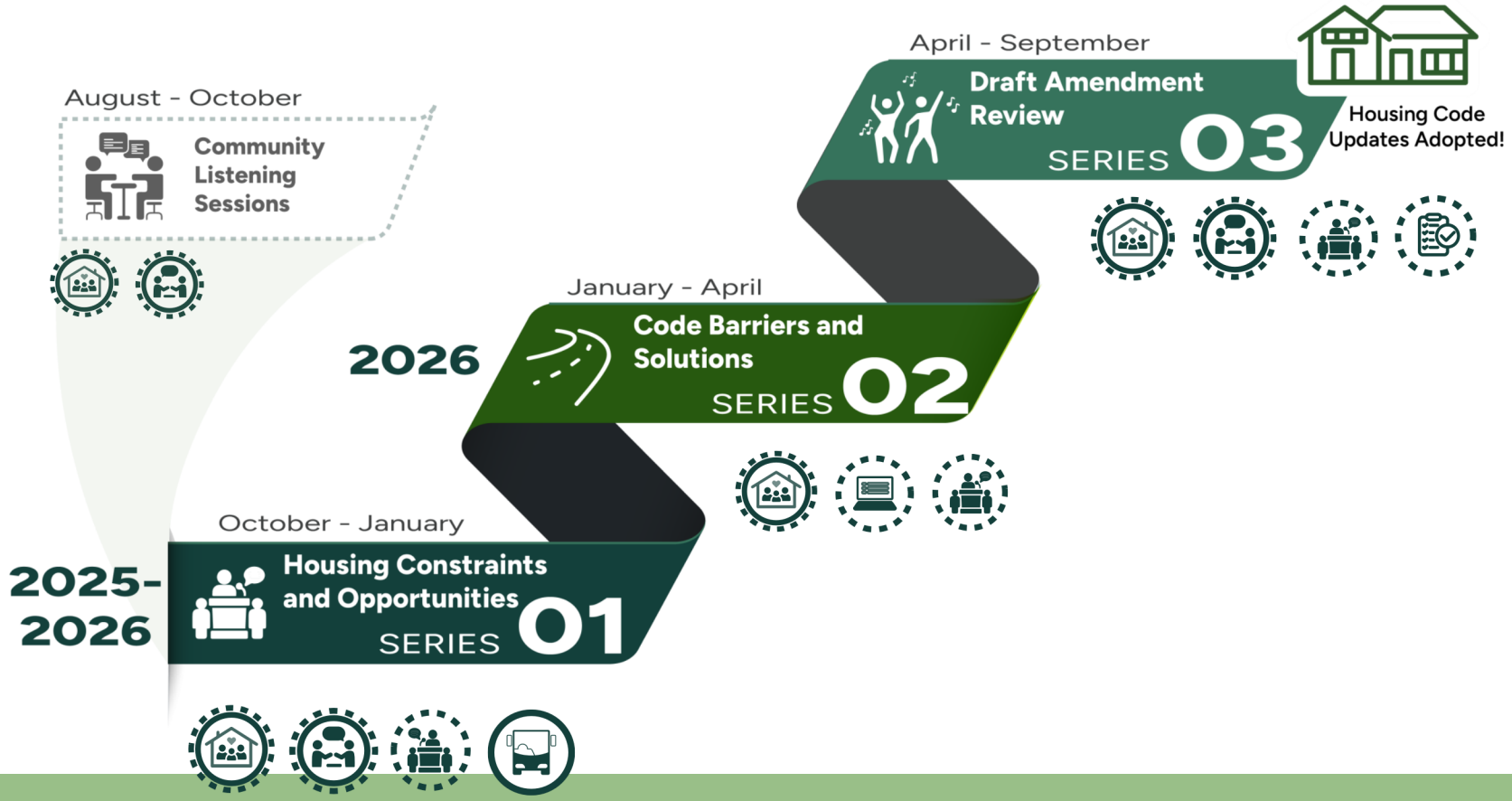
- Unlocks future state funding through Proposition 123 compliance
- Implements existing community plans through concrete code changes
- Enable diverse housing types: ADUs, tiny homes, starter homes, and workforce housing
- Reduce regulatory barriers and streamline development processes

Through a Community Driven Process, we will:

- **ASSESS** current zoning regulations, development standards, and permitting processes
- **IDENTIFY** where unnecessary complexity, costs, or delays prevent housing production
- **REMOVE** these barriers by amending the land use code



Overview and Timeline



Outreach and Success Measures

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Community Engagement Approach

Transparent about trade-offs **Multiple ways to participate**

Full Spectrum of Engagement

INFORM → CONSULT → INVOLVE → COLLABORATE → EMPOWER

Goal: Well-informed community decisions that reflect our shared values

- Balanced perspectives from all stakeholders
- Clear understanding of tradeoffs and impacts

Community-Wide Outreach

Multiple Engagement Formats:

- Community Listening Sessions and one-on-ones
- Focus groups & targeted sessions with stakeholders
- Public community events in different county areas
- Interactive activities (mapping, visualization, ride-alongs)
- Digital engagement (online surveys, comment portals)
- Government meetings (PC/BOCC work sessions)

Strategic Stakeholder Roundtable (SSR)

Purpose

Collaborative working group to identify housing barriers and develop practical solutions
Members serve as community liaisons, sharing information and gathering feedback

Formation Timeline

August 20th
Applications Due

August 27th
BOCC Approval

SSR Composition

GEO
Geography

SECTOR
Economic Sector

LIVED EXP
Housing Experience

10-12 member collaborative working group
- Application-based selection process
- Balanced representation across county
- 6 meetings with full transparency
- Materials posted within 72 hours

Success Measures

- Participation from long-distance commuters
- Input from diverse economic sectors and employers
- Representation from different geographic areas
- Meaningful dialogue about lessons learned from past initiatives
- Community understanding of regulatory barriers
- Fully transparent process

Project Phases

Phase I – Project Kick-Off

- Refining schedule
- Draft Community Engagement Plan
- Defining Strategic Stakeholder group
- Reviewing existing plans and documents

Phase II – Issue Identification and Analysis

- Existing Code Analysis and Constraints Review
- Three Public Outreach Series
- Preliminary Code Audit Report

Series 1: Housing Constraints and Opportunities

2025

Sept - Dec

- Focus groups
- Community listening sessions
- Data visualization workshops
- Other engagement opportunities like ride-alongs on the Norwood SMART bus route

Focus

- The economic impact (costs and availability)
- The regulatory barriers
- The infrastructure reality
- The community balance everyone cares about

Series 2: Code Barriers and Solutions

2026

Jan - Mar

- Technical workshops and visual presentations showing "what could be built" under different regulatory scenarios
- Interactive mapping and community design workshops exploring housing types
- Infrastructure capacity discussions with utility providers

Focus

- Identify biggest regulatory barriers
- Streamline review processes
- Reduce unnecessary cost drivers
- Learn from other mountain communities

Series 3: Draft Amendment Review

2026

Apr - July

- Public presentations of draft code amendments
- Geographic-specific meetings and design workshops "Office hours" for one-on-one consultations on draft amendments
- Planning Commission and BOCC work sessions (public attendance encouraged)
- Online comment portal for detailed feedback on specific code provisions

Focus

- Review proposed amendments against barriers
- Present development impact analysis Identify needed modifications
- Balance housing production with character preservation

Phase III – Final Audit Report and Code Drafting

Public Review Process: The draft Land Use Code updates will be posted online for public review for at least 30 days prior to public hearings to gather final community input.

Final Presentations: In Fall 2026, the final project presentations and hearings will be given at a joint session of the Planning Commission and Board of County Commissioners.

Questions?

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